MIL-D-52121B
14 November 1974
SUPERSEDING
MIL-D-52121A
14 August 1968

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

DRILL, PNEUMATIC, SINKER, ROCK

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a portable drill.

1.2 Classification. The drill shall be of the 55 pound class (see 6.3).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

WW-C-633	- Couplings, Hose; (Half), Pneumatic, Universal Type.
ZZ-H-500	- Hose, Rubber, and Hose Assemblies, Rubber; Pneumatic (Yarn or Fabric Reinforced).
PPP-B-636	- Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-P-40	- Packaging and Packing of Hand Tools.

Military

MIL-P-514	- Plates, Identification, Instruction and Marking, Blank.
MIL-T-704	- Treatment and Painting of Materiel.
MIL-C-11760	- Clamps, Hose, Pneumatic, for Universal Couplings.
MIL-O-13417	- Oilers, Air Line, for Pneumatic Tools.

FSC 3820

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STANDARDS

Federal

FED. STD. No. 595	- Colors.

Military

MIL-STD-100	- Engineering Drawing Practices.
MIL-STD-129	- Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-130	- Identification Marking of US Military Property.
MIL-STD-781	- Reliability Tests: Exponential Distribution.
MIL-STD-1474	- Noise Limits for Army Materiel.
MS35647	- Padlocks, Key Operated.
MS35793	- Handle, Bail-Chest, Surface Mounting, Plain Holes.
MS35829	- Hinge, Continuous (Piano), .075 Thickness, .187 and .250 Pin Dia.
MS39125	- Drill Rods and Bits, Star, Rock Drill for Drill, Pneumatic, Sinker.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Description. The pneumatic drill shall be of the dry-blower, self-rotating type, and shall be for use with hollow-centered drill rod having collared hexagon shanks conforming to MS39125. The drill shall operate as specified herein on air pressures ranging from 70 to 100 pounds per square inch gage (psig). The drill shall be cushioned against vibration to permit the required performance. The drill shall consist essentially of backhead, cylinder, and fronthead.

3.1.1 Weight. The drill shall weigh not less than 55 pounds or more than 65 pounds.

3.1.2 Performance characteristics. The drill, when drilling, with the throttle fully open shall use not more than 135 cubic feet per minute (cfm) of free air. The drill when blowing air at full capacity shall not use less than 85 cfm of free air. The air consumption and air flow requirements shall be met with the drill operating on air pressure of 90 psig at the tool.

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3.1.3 Performance. When tested as specified in 4.6.2.2, the minimum average drilling rate using a 1-3/4 inch diameter, 4 point carbide bit, shall be 14 inches per minute. The drill shall be capable of drilling the full length of a 20 foot long drill rod into homogeneous rock, with an average specific gravity of not less than 2.6, using a bit of not less than 1-5/8 inch diameter.

3.1.4 Interchangeability. All parts having the same manufacturer's part number shall be functionally and dimensionally interchangeable. The drawing number requirements of MIL-STD-100 shall govern changes in the supplier's part number.

3.1.5 Maintainability.

3.1.5.1 Maintenance support. Assemblages or support elements such as technical manuals, repair parts, special tools, or lubrication charts, as specified (see 6.6 and 6.7), shall be adequate to perform the intended function of assisting or conducting maintenance operations when tested as specified in 4.6.2.7.

3.1.5.2 Maintenance ratio. The drill shall have a maintenance ratio of not more than .05. Maintenance ratio is defined as the ratio of the total active maintenance man-hours required (scheduled and unscheduled) to the total operating time. Man-hours for repair of replaced components and scheduled before-and-after operation checks are excluded. A maintenance schedule shall be furnished prior to the start of any testing.

3.1.6 Reliability. The specified Mean-Time-Between-Failure (MTBF) shall be 50 hours when the drill is tested as specified in 4.6.2.8.

3.1.7 Environmental. The drill shall be capable of operating as specified herein in any ambient temperature from 0° F to 125° F.

3.2 First article (preproduction model). The supplier shall furnish one or more drills as specified (see 6.2), for examination and testing within the time frame specified (see 6.2), to prove prior to starting production, that his production methods and choice of design detail will produce drills that comply with the requirements of this specification. Examination and tests shall be as specified in Section 4; and, unless otherwise specified herein, all examinations and tests shall be conducted by the supplier subject to surveillance and approval by the Government (see 6.4). When specified (see 6.2), the Government will conduct any or all of the preproduction examination and tests, as specified (see 6.2).

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3.3 Initial production. When specified (see 6.2), the supplier shall furnish to the Government one or more drills for testing as specified in 4.4.

3.4 Material. Material shall be as specified herein. Material not specified shall be selected by the supplier and shall be subject to all provisions of this specification.

3.5 Safety. Each drill shall be provided with a retainer and centralizer which will prevent the drill rod from becoming accidentally disengaged from the drill.

3.6 Backhead, cylinder, and fronthead. The backhead, cylinder, and fronthead shall be constructed of drop-forged, heat-treated steel and shall be rigidly connected and alined. There shall be no undue projections from the sides.

3.6.1 Backhead assembly. The backhead assembly shall consist essentially of a housing and a T-handle. The T-handle shall be removable from the backhead and shall have replaceable, rubber-cushioned grips.

3.6.2 Cylinder assembly. The cylinder assembly shall consist essentially of a housing containing a rotation mechanism, an automatic valve for controlling air direction, a piston, and an exhaust port.

3.6.2.1 Cylinder components. The cylinder shall have an air cushion at both ends of the piston stroke to prevent damage to drill components. The cylinder shall permit stable support on a flat surface for horizontal drilling.

3.6.2.2 Inlet port valve. The inlet port valve shall automatically control the direction of air required for operation of the piston.

3.6.2.3 Rotation mechanism. The rotation mechanism shall consist of a ratchet and pawl mechanism and attached rifle bar arranged to provide automatic counter-clockwise rotation of the drill rod chuck on return stroke of the piston. The rifle bar shall provide 1 revolution for every 25 to 35 strokes.

3.6.2.4 Piston. The piston shall be center bored and fitted with a renewable bronze nut for engagement with the rifle bar. The striking end of the piston shall have longitudinal splines engaging with the chuck nut or rotating sleeve to permit rotation of the drill rod chuck by the action of the rotation mechanism.

3.6.2.5 Exhaust port. The exhaust port shall be located to direct the exhaust air away from the operator.

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3.6.3 Fronthead assembly. The fronthead assembly shall consist essentially of a housing containing the chuck, chuck nut, and drill rod retainer and shall permit rapid removal and replacement of steels.

3.6.3.1 Chuck and chuck nut. The drill rod chuck shall accomodate drill rods having shanks conforming to MS39125. The chuck rotating sleeve shall be fitted with a renewable bronze chuck nut having internal longitudinal splines to receive the splined striking end of the piston and shall rotate the rod by action of the rotation mechanism.

3.6.3.2 Drill rod retainer. The drill rod retainer shall be constructed of forged steel and shall be secured to the fronthead housing with vibration-cushioned bolts or pins or by a spring-locked lever.

3.7 Air-inlet connection. The air-inlet connection shall be swivel connected to the drill to permit positioning without restraint from an attached air-supply hose. The end of the air connection shall be threaded with a male 3/4-inch American National taper pipe thread.

3.8 Throttle valve. The throttle valve shall be located on either the backhead or cylinder housing and shall be operable during drilling without the operator losing control of the drill. The throttle shall have not less than three positive, self-locking positions: Off, hole collaring, and full throttle.

3.9 Blower valve. Blowing shall be accomplished by an automatic continuous blowing arrangement which functions while the drill is operating, supplemented by a manually positioned blower valve operated either by a separate control or by alternate positioning of the throttle valve control. The automatic continuous blowing arrangement shall function to keep the drill cuttings away from beneath the face of the bit. The blower valve shall function to direct air through the drill to the chuck and hollow drill rod.

3.10 Leader hose assembly. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), a hose assembly conforming to ZZ-H-500 shall be furnished. The assembly shall consist of a 10-foot long, 3/4-inch-inside diameter hose conforming to ZZ-H-500, Class 1 and with 3/4-inch universal hose couplings conforming to WW-C-633, Type I, on both ends, attached to hose by clamps conforming to MIL-C-11760, Size 1.

3.11 Coupling half. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), a coupling half conforming to WW-C-633, Type II, Size 3/4-inch, shall be furnished.

3.12 Noise limits. The noise of the drill shall not exceed the limits specified in MIL-STD-1474, Category A for steady-state noise when tested in accordance with 4.6.2.5.1. The sound level shall comply with the exterior noise requirements of MIL-STD-1474 when tested in accordance with 4.6.2.5.2

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(aural nondetectability and impulse noise do not apply). The precautions of MIL-STD-1474 (see 6.5), shall be provided if the sound level exceeds 85dB(A) when tested in accordance with 4.6.2.5.1. Hearing protectors shall not be supplied with the drill. Hazard signs, when required, shall state "CAUTION, HEARING PROTECTION REQUIRED". Plates shall be in accordance with MIL-P-514, Type III, Composition C of Type I, Grade A, Class 1 material.

3.13 Identification marking. The drill shall be identified in accordance with MIL-STD-130. The required marking shall be applied directly to the housing surface by metal stamp or forging.

3.14 Treatment and painting. The portions of the drill and the components and parts normally painted shall be cleaned, treated, and painted in accordance with MIL-T-704, Type C, lusterless finish, Color No. 34087, FED. STD. No. 595.

3.15 Chest. When specified (see 6.2), a chest made of steel not less than 0.071 inch in thickness shall be furnished and shall be of a size to hold the maintenance tools, leader hose, drill, and repair parts as applicable. The chest lid shall be secured to one edge of a side by a continuous hinge extending the full length of the chest edge. The hinge shall conform to MS35829-7C. The lid shall be held in the closed position by not less than two hook type tension latches with strikers bolted or riveted to the chest and to the lid. A hasp shall be provided to secure the lid to the chest and accommodate a lock conforming to MS35647. Two lifting handles conforming to MS35793 shall be provided, one located at each end of the chest. The lid shall remain in the fully open position by the weight of the lid or by holding devices.

3.16 Workmanship. The drill shall be free of defects such as galvanic action resulting from contact or dissimilar metals, rust, cracks, and other defects that could impair its operation or serviceability. All parts, components, and assemblies of the drill including castings, forgings, molded parts, stampings, bearings, seals, and machined surfaces shall be clean and sound and free from sand, dirt, fins, sprues, scale, and other harmful extraneous materials. All edges shall be rounded or chamfered.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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4.2 Classification of inspections. Inspections shall be classified as follows:

(a) Preproduction inspection (see 4.3).
(b) Initial production inspection (see 4.4).
(c) Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).
(d) Inspection comparison (see 4.7).
(e) Inspection of preparation for delivery (see 4.8).

4.3 Preproduction inspection.

4.3.1 Examination. The drill shall be examined as specified in 4.6.1. Presence of one or more defects shall be cause for rejection.

4.3.2 Tests. The drill shall be tested as specified in 4.6.2 through 4.6.2.5. Failure of any test shall be cause for rejection.

4.4 Initial production inspection. When specified (see 3.3), one or more initial production drills will be selected at random by the Government from the drills being produced by production tooling and will be examined as specified in 4.6.1 and tested as specified in 4.6.2.7 and 4.6.2.8 to determine conformance to the requirements of this specification. The inspection will be performed by the Government at a site selected by the Government. Acceptance of an initial production drill shall not exclude the remaining drills from the quality conformance inspection and acceptance provisions specified in Section 4. In addition to any test specified as part of the initial production test, the Government reserves the right to conduct any and all other tests contained in this specification as part of the initial production test and failure of such additional tests shall have the same effect as failure of those tests specified as initial production tests.

4.4.1 Inspection failure. Failure of an initial production drill to meet any requirement specified herein during and as a result of the examination and tests specified in 4.4 shall be cause for rejection of the initial production drill(s) and shall be cause for refusal by the Government to continue acceptance of production drills until evidence has been provided by the supplier that corrective action has been taken to eliminate the deficiencies. Correction of such deficiencies shall be accomplished by the supplier at no cost to the Government on drills previously accepted and produced under the contract. Any deficiencies found as a result of the initial production inspection will be considered prima facie evidence that all drills accepted prior to the completion of initial production inspection are similarly deficient unless evidence to the contrary is furnished by the supplier and such evidence is acceptable to the contracting officer.

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4.5 Quality conformance inspection.

4.5.1 Examination. Each drill shall be examined for the defects specified in 4.6.1. Presence of one or more defects shall be cause for rejection.

4.5.2 Tests. Each drill except the preproduction model and the initial production drill(s) shall be tested as specified in 4.6.2.6. Failure of the test shall be cause for rejection.

4.6 Inspection procedure.

4.6.1 Examination. The drill shall be examined as specified herein, for the following defects:

Major

101. Weight not as specified (see 3.1.1).
102. Material not as specified (see 3.4).
103. Retainer not as specified (see 3.5 and 3.6.3.2).
104. Backhead assembly not as specified (see 3.6 and 3.6.1).
105. Cylinder assembly not as specified (see 3.6 and 3.6.2).
106. Valves not as specified (see 3.6.2.2, 3.8 and 3.9).
107. Rotation mechanism not as specified (see 3.6.2.3).
108. Piston not as specified (see 3.6.2.4).
109. Chuck not as specified (see 3.6.3.1).
110. Chuck nut or rotating sleeve not replaceable (see 3.6.3.1).
111. Air inlet connection not as specified (see 3.7).

Minor

201. Identification markings not as specified (see 3.13).
202. Treatment and painting not as specified (see 3.14).
203. Workmanship not as specified (see 3.17).

4.6.2 Tests. Prior to test the drill shall be lubricated with military oils. Oils shall be those designated for use in the ambient temperatures at which the test is being performed. An air-line oiler conforming to MIL-O-13417, furnished by the supplier, shall be used to supply oil for lubrication to the drill being tested.

4.6.2.1 Run-in. The drill shall be operated for at least 20 hours of drilling in ordinary rock. The air pressure shall be varied over the range specified in 3.1. During the test, the air exhaust shall be examined periodically for the presence of oil vapor. Inability of the operator to use the throttle valve without losing control of the drill, evidence that the attached air supply hose interferes with the positioning of the drill, a lack of oil vapor at the air exhaust or inability of the drill to operate at all pressures in the specified range shall constitute failure of this test.

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4.6.2.2 Performance. The drill shall be operated as follows in Barre granite using 1-3/4-inch diameter, 4-point, centerhold, tungsten-carbide-insert detachable bits and standard 1-inch hexagon drill rod 2 feet in length. The source of compressed air shall be capable of delivering air through a 3/4-inch rubber air hose at a minimum pressure of 125 psig at a rate of 210 cfm. A pressure regulating valve shall be set to maintain 90 psi at the tool. A line oiler filled with lubricating oil shall be included in the air line. A starter hole approximately 1.2-inch deep shall be first drilled. Using the starter hole, a hole shall be then drilled the full length of the drill steel with a single drill bit. The time to drill the hole shall be recorded and the depth of the hole shall be measured. The depth of the starter hole shall be subtracted from the total depth of the hole. The test shall be repeated 10 times. Both air consumption and blowing air shall be measured with a water displacement meter or pulsation compensated flow meter. Total air consumption shall be measured at 90 psig. The quantity of blowing air consumed, at 90 psig, shall be measured with a drill rod inserted and extending a minimum of 2 feet into a drilled hole, exhaust port closed, drill blowing air only, and the operator applying full pressure to the drill for a period of 1 minute. Inability to drill at the average rate specified in 3.1.2, total air consumption of free air exceeding that specified in 3.1.2, or blowing air at less than the amount specified in 3.1.2 shall constitute failure of this test.

4.6.2.3 Deep hole drilling. The drill shall be operated in homogeneous rock with an average specific gravity of not less than 2.6. Three holes having 1-5/8-inch minimum diameter shall be drilled, to the depth specified in 3.1.3. The air pressure shall be 70 psig at the tool. Inability to drill holes to the depth specified in 3.1.3 shall constitute failure of this test.

4.6.2.4 Leader hose assembly. When a leader hose assembly is furnished, test the assembly in accordance with ZZ-H-500.

4.6.2.5 Noise level measurement.

4.6.2.5.1 Operator's station. Measure the noise at the operator's station in accordance with MIL-STD-1474 for steady-state noise at the operating condition of drilling rock on a surface of rock. Nonconformance to 3.12 shall constitute failure of this test.

4.6.2.5.2 Exterior spectator position. Measure the exterior noise level in accordance with MIL-STD-1474. Nonconformance to 3.12 shall constitute failure of this test.

4.6.2.6 Individual operation. Operate each drill for 10 minutes at 90 psig. Any operational difficulties, breakage, or permanent deformation shall constitute failure of this test.

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4.6.2.7 Maintainability

4.6.2.7.1 Maintenance support evaluation. Maintenance operations required during initial production testing shall be accomplished to determine conformance to 3.1.5.1. Failure of the support elements to maintain the drill as specified shall constitute failure of this test. Errors or inadequacies in the manuals shall not be considered in assessing the maintenance ratio or the MTBF.

4.6.2.7.2 Maintenance ratio. The maintenance ratio shall be computed during initial production testing. Nonconformance to 3.1.5.1 shall constitute failure of this test.

4.6.2.8 Reliability. Using the MTBF specified in 3.1.5.2 the drill shall be tested as specified in 4.6.2.1 with "accept" and "reject" criteria in accordance with MIL-STD-781, Test Plan VIII. Continue testing until either an "accept" or "reject" decision is reached. A failure is defined as any malfunction which cannot be corrected within 60 minutes (all waiting periods are excluded) by adjustment, repair, or replacement action using controls and on-equipment tools or parts available to the using element, and is a malfunction which causes or may cause one or more of the following:

(a) Failure to commence operation, cessation of operation, or degradation of performance below specified levels.
(b) Damage to the drill by continued operation.
(c) Safety hazards to personnel.

Nonconformance to 3.1.5.2 shall constitute failure of this test.

4.7 Inspection comparison. The Government may select drills at any time during the contract production period and subject these drills to the examination specified in 4.6.1 and the tests specified in 4.6.2 to determine conformance to the requirements of this specification. The inspection will be performed by the Government, at a site selected by the Government, on units selected at random from those which have been accepted by the Government and will not include the previously inspected preproduction model and initial production drills. In addition to any test specified as part of the inspection comparison, the Government reserves the right to conduct any and all other tests contained in this specification as part of the inspection comparison and failure of such additional tests shall have the same effect as failure of those tests specified as inspection comparison.

4.7.1 Inspection failure. Failure of an inspection comparison drill to meet any requirement specified herein during and as a result of the examination and tests specified in 4.7 shall be cause for rejection of the inspection

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comparison drill(s) and shall be cause for refusal by the Government to continue acceptance of production drills until evidence has been provided by the supplier that corrective action has been taken to eliminate the deficiencies. Correction of such deficiencies shall be accomplished by the supplier at no cost to the Government on drills previously accepted and produced under the contract. Any deficiencies found as a result of the inspection comparison will be considered prima facie evidence that all drills accepted prior to the completion of inspection comparison are similarly deficient unless evidence to the contrary is furnished by the supplier and such evidence is acceptable to the contracting officer.

4.8 Inspection of preparation for delivery.

4.8.1 Quality conformance inspection of pack. The preservation, packaging, packing, and marking of the drill and associated equipment shall be examined to determine compliance with the quality conformance inspection requirements of PPP-P-40.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation and packaging. Preservation and packaging shall be Level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Each drill with repair parts, tools, and technical publications shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with PPP-P-40, Level A utilizing the chest provided (see 3.15). When a chest is not provided, each drill with repair parts, tools, and technical publications shall be consolidated packaged in a fiberboard box conforming to PPP-B-636, V3c or greater. Fiberboard boxes shall be closed Method V of the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.2 Level C. The drills with repair parts, tools, and technical publications shall be packaged to afford protection against deterioration and damage during shipment from the supplier to the initial destination. The chest when furnished (see 3.15), shall be used as the packaging container.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be in accordance with PPP-P-40, Level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2). Fiberboard containers used for Level B packing shall be Class Weather-Resistant and waterproof sealed.

5.3 Marking. Marking of packages and shipping containers shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The drills are intended for drilling holes in rock, brick and concrete for general construction and maintenance work.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Time frame required for submission of the preproduction model and number of drills required (see 3.2).
(c) When the Government will conduct any or all of the preproduction model examination and tests. When the Government will conduct some but not all of the preproduction examination and tests, the contracting officer should specify which examination and tests will be conducted by the Government and which examination and tests shall be conducted by the supplier (see 3.2).
(d) When initial production inspection is required (see 3.3).
(e) When a leader hose is not to be furnished (see 3.10).
(f) When coupling half is not to be furnished (see 3.11).
(h) When a chest is required (see 3.15).
(i) Level of preservation and packaging and level of packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 Classification change. Class 1 and Class 2 drills have been deleted from this edition of the specification because they are no longer required.

6.4 Preproduction model. Any changes or deviations of production drills from the approved preproduction model during production will be subject to the approval of the contracting officer. Approval of the preproduction model will not relieve the supplier of his obligation to furnish drills conforming to this specification.

6.5 Noise limits. When the noise level of the drill exceeds 85dB(A), the appropriate discussion of the noise hazard in accordance with MIL-STD-1474 (MANUALS Paragraph) shall include the requirement for hearing protection, the noise level of the drill, the distance from the drill at which 85dB(A) will always be met, and what operational situation or system configuration will reduce the level to 85dB(A).

6.6 Data requirements. The contracting officer should include requirements for such data as technical publications, instructional materials, illustrated parts lists, and supplier's maintenance and operation manual to be furnished with each drill.

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6.7 Provisioning. The contracting officer should include provisioning requirements for repair parts and maintenance tools as necessary (including any special tools), and instructions on shipment of drills.

6.8 This document was prepared by USAMERDC for USATACOM.

Custodians:

Army - AT
Navy - YD

User activity:

Army - CE

Review activities:

Navy - MC
DSA - CS

Preparing activity:

Army - AT

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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